

that were interviewed. At least they were being truthful, but take this as a negative example.

Concepting

This is the creative ideation part of the process. Despite the many digital tools available online, paper rules! There is hardly any designer who doesn't use quick messy sketching or some other paper prototyping form at the early stage of a design process! Designers utilize the information gathered in the first step of the process and find a design worth refining. "This stage is about artistic fury and creative explosion", where designers must formulate the intended User Experience.

Design

In contrast to the anti-documentation Agile approach where teams start building features from the start, most designers create wireframes and prototypes to document the experience and then hand them to the developers to create. To put it simply, the UX designers create the form, while developers and visual designers symbiotically create the matter. According to popular opinion, Heuristic Evaluation is definitely out of fashion, and instead, expert review backed up with a cognitive walkthrough is quite popular.

Approval

This is surprisingly an important part of the real world UX design process. Research documents and deliverables are found to serve as persuading factors in the 'buy in' process. A lot of UX designers actually create a special presentation to tell clients the design story, because it is extremely important for them to buy into the product, both physically and psychologically. The presentation shows stages of the process, deliverables and interactions, and aims to give clients easy access to as much comprehensible information as possible. If the stakeholders don't 'buy in', then there is no product, no project and most importantly, no pay.

These differences mostly arise from constraints on time, budget, and other practicalities that come in the way of the ideal UX Design process. To cope with this some people follow a Lean UX methodology that combines some of the principles of Agile software development with UX design.

Ultimately, the aim is to create a product which people would want to use, and these are all the ways to create. Everyone has their own constraints, be it a budget, deadlines or even their own laziness, and it isn't possible to